

Week 5 Make: GIF & Remix Culture

Name: Sofia Zafiropulos

Title: *Valentine Dog*

Tools Used: DALL·E (gif generation)

Reflection

When an image repeats rather than standing still, it shifts from a single moment into a continuous action. Instead of just observing the dog barking once, the loop creates a rhythm that feels alive and ongoing. This repetition draws attention because the motion never resolves, keeping the viewer engaged and allowing them to notice small details in the expression and movement.

Looping intensifies emotion and meaning. Because the dog gets closer and repeats endlessly, it appears extra energetic, which heightens the cuteness and humor of the heart spots on its body. This continuous cycle encourages engagement in a way a still photo would not.

Human choice is involved in deciding which moment to animate and what emotion the GIF conveys. I chose a specific frame sequence that emphasized the dog's motion to make it feel playful rather than chaotic. The other human choice was with the image I chose to loop and created a frame of the dog moving closer to the viewer to make it feel more realistic.

Automation and pattern appear in how the GIF is generated and repeated. Once the frames are selected, the looping occurs mechanically, repeating the same sequence over and over. The repetition becomes a programmed pattern, showing how digital media turns moments into endlessly reproducible actions.

AI complicates authorship and originality because it helped me generate the GIF by enhancing the animation, but the creative intent still came from human direction. While the AI helped animate the image into motion, I made the conceptual decisions about framing and what I wanted the dog to do. This blurs the line between creator and tool, raising questions about whether the final product belongs to me or the system that generated it.

Attribution & AI Use

- **Tools used:** Dalle (GIF generator)
- **AI prompts (if any):** "Take this image and create a gif of this exact dog moving closer to the screen to make it realistically seem like it is coming toward the viewer"
- **What the AI generated:** A gif of the dog moving toward the screen (did exactly what I asked)
- **What you changed, edited, or remixed:** I changed the file size, the first one DALLE gave to me was over 10MB and I asked it to make the file size smaller than 10 MB.
- **Sources of any reused material (if applicable):**
https://www.instagram.com/p/DURWzpCjBiF/?img_index=1